

CAREER PATHS

Some specialized positions require additional training and qualifications. Airmen can advance to senior roles that might include commanding an air base, making tactical decisions, or liaising with government officials. After leaving the armed forces, airmen may choose to retrain as commercial pilots or instructors.

HIGH SCHOOL GRADUATE

You must have a high school diploma or a GED with 15 or more college credits to enlist in the US Air Force. Strong math and English skills are necessary for passing the military's entrance exam.

COLLEGE GRADUATE

With a college degree, you are able to enter the Air Force as an officer. Some specialties may require a master's degree.



AIR FORCE AIRMAN You begin your training with Basic Combat Training (BCT); airmanship skills are taught along with conditioning to become physically fit. After BCT, airmen become experts in their fields of choice by attending Air Force Technical Training.



SPACE SYSTEMS OPERATIONS SPECIALIST

Detects sea-launched ballistic missiles, and tracks satellites to assist in rocket launches and space flight operations.



COMBAT RESCUE OFFICER Organizes and strategizes recovery missions. Conducts rescue and recovery operations to evacuate injured servicemen from the front lines.



AIRCRAFT LOADMASTER

Loads aircraft and ensures passengers or cargo arrive safely at their destination. May participate in air deliveries using parachutes.



FUELS SPECIALIST

Receives, stores, and tracks all fuel for vehicles and aircraft on a daily basis. Maintains the facility where the fuel is stored; ensures planes and helicopters are properly fueled before they head out on a mission.

SKILLS GUIDE



The ability to communicate critical, often very technical information clearly and quickly.



The ability to create an effective work unit while supporting the objectives of a team.



Flexibility and readiness to carry out training and missions, often at a moment's notice.



An analytical approach and the ability to solve problems quickly and think clearly under stress.



Capability of meeting the many physical and mental challenges that come with air operations.



Attention to detail and precise thinking to fly advanced aircraft and correctly carry out orders.